MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検準2級プラス
リーディングトレーニング

第15回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検準2級プラス形式のリーディング第15回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) To ( ) wear on historic tatami mats, visitors tour the tea pavilion in clean white socks.

1 mobilize **2** maximize **3** memorize **4** minimize

(2) In the ( ) of an elevator power outage, press the yellow intercom button and stay calm.

1 effect **2** event **3** effort **4** extent

(3) Because freshly roasted coffee beans release carbon dioxide for days, bags include a one-way valve to let gas ( ).

1 establish **2** escort **3** escape **4** estimate

(4) Little ( ) the young baker dream that her walnut sourdough would win a national medal within two years.

1 did **2** was **3** had **4** does

(5) After three rainy weekends in a row, local strawberry farmers are behind ( ) with spring planting.

1 scale **2** season **3** scheme **4** schedule

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(6) When the projector bulb burned out mid-lecture, Professor Ono fell back (　　) chalk diagrams without missing a beat.

1 on　**2** to　**3** in　**4** at

(7) To ensure fair judging, all student piano contestants play behind a thin screen that conceals their (　　).

1 intensity　**2** identity　**3** immunity　**4** infinity

(8) Weather (　　), the astronomy club will set up six telescopes on the athletic field tonight.

1 permits　**2** permitted　**3** permitting　**4** to permit

(9) Once the new bypass tunnel opens in November, heavy logging trucks will no longer pass (　　) our narrow school road.

1 among　**2** along　**3** aboard　**4** aside

(10) Although both printers cost the same upfront, the laser model is far more economical in the long (　　).

1 turn　**2** way　**3** walk　**4** run

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(11) Because sea breezes carry corrosive salt mist inland, coastal traffic signals require stainless-steel brackets resistant to (　　).

1 rust　**2** rash　**3** rift　**4** rout

(12) The archivist handled the brittle 1880 letter with cotton tweezers for fear of (　　) its folded corners.

1 torn　**2** tear　**3** tearing　**4** tears

(13) Far from replacing local bookshops, the town's monthly outdoor book market has sparked renewed (　　) in print reading.

1 incident　**2** instinct　**3** interval　**4** interest

(14) Should any lab burner flame turn yellow instead of blue, (　　) the air collar slightly until combustion clears.

1 adjusted　**2** adjusts　**3** adjust　**4** adjusting

(15) To keep hot soup from cracking a cold ceramic bowl, chefs warm the vessel with tap water (　　).

1 backward　**2** beforehand　**3** beside　**4** beneath

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(16) Our track coach stresses that steady eight-hour sleep counts every bit as (　　) as interval sprints.

1 much　**2** many　**3** more　**4** most

(17) After the typhoon passed, harbor crews worked around the (　　) to clear driftwood from ferry lanes.

1 dial　**2** watch　**3** hour　**4** clock

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Train Tracks Rest on Beds of Crushed Stone

Glance down from a station platform along almost any conventional railway line, and the steel rails and crossties sit atop a thick bed of jagged gray stones rather than smooth asphalt or solid soil. Railway engineers call this angular crushed granite or basalt "track ballast," and its rough edges perform a surprisingly sophisticated mechanical job every time a four-hundred-ton train thunders past.

If crossties were laid directly on bare earth, rainwater would turn the ground muddy, weeds would sprout through the ties, and uneven settling would bend steel rails within weeks. Pouring smooth round river pebbles wouldn't work either: round stones roll over one another like marbles under heavy axle loads. Sharp, multi-sided ballast stones, by contrast, lock tightly together into an elastic mattress. When train wheels press downward, interlocking stones spread that immense weight across a wide strip of ground while flexing by tiny millimeters to cushion vibration. (18), rainwater drains straight through the open gaps between stones in seconds.

High-speed shinkansen viaducts and subway tunnels do use solid concrete "slab track" where precise alignment justifies higher upfront cost. On open rural lines, however, crushed ballast wins on maintainability: when ground settles slightly over years, maintenance machines simply lift the ties and tamp fresh stone underneath overnight. (19), open stone pores absorb wheel noise that hard concrete slabs bounce upward into train windows.

Humble crushed rock proves that centuries-old engineering materials endure when they combine (20).

(18)

1 On the contrary
2 At the same time
3 Otherwise
4 In vain

(19)

1 Instead of trains
2 Conversely
3 As a bonus
4 Previously

(20)

1 strength, drainage, quietness, and easy repair at low cost
2 smooth round marbles with muddy garden soil
3 louder wheel echoes and permanent rainwater puddles
4 zero maintenance machines on rural lines

How Repair Cafés Extend Product Lifespans and Neighborhood Ties

Buy an electric toaster, desk fan, or winter coat today, and a single snapped switch or stuck zipper often sends the entire item to the trash bin. Manufacturers frequently seal plastic housings with glue rather than screws, while commercial repair shops must charge labor fees that rival the price of a cheap replacement. Across more than two thousand towns worldwide—having started in Amsterdam in 2009—community volunteers have built a welcoming response: the monthly "Repair Café."

Held in libraries, church basements, or civic centers on Saturday afternoons, a Repair Café pairs retired engineers, tailors, carpenters, and tech-savvy students with neighbors carrying broken household goods. Visitors pay nothing except optional donations for spare fuses or thread. Crucially, the café is not a drop-off counter; owners pull up a chair and hold the flashlight or screwdriver alongside the fixer. (21), demystifying how a coffee maker or bicycle brake works gives people confidence to tackle minor upkeep at home.

Volunteer groups log every attempted repair in a shared international database, successfully reviving roughly two-thirds of items brought in. Beyond keeping tons of metals and textiles out of landfills, those records now inform "right-to-repair" lawmakers pressing appliance makers to supply spare parts and screw-together designs. (22), elderly craftspeople living alone gain a lively monthly venue where younger neighbors genuinely value their decades of practical skill.

Sharing tools over a cup of tea shows how local grassroots action can (23).

(21)

1 In vain
2 On the contrary
3 Otherwise
4 In this way

(22)

1 On a human level
2 Conversely
3 Instead of tools
4 Reluctantly

(23)

1 glue every toaster shut so nobody can open it
2 cut household waste while reconnecting generations in a community
3 charge higher repair fees than brand-new appliances
4 throw away two-thirds of working bicycles

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Microphone Rules for the English Speech Contest

From: Stage Crew, Prefectural English Speech Contest
To: Finalist Speakers
Subject: Lapel vs. handheld mic choice and silent-switch rule for Sunday

Dear finalists,
Congratulations on reaching Sunday's Prefectural Final at Civic Small Hall! Sound checks run from 9:15 a.m. to 9:50 a.m. in contestant order.

Each speaker may choose either the fixed podium microphone or a wireless handheld microphone; please tell the sound desk your choice at check-in so crew members can set stand height beforehand. Gesture-heavy speakers often prefer the podium mic so both hands stay free.

If you choose the handheld mic, NEVER tap or blow into the grille to test whether it is on—that sends a painful boom through the hall speakers. Our sound engineer unmutes your channel the moment you bow at center stage; simply hold the mic a fist's width below your chin and begin speaking naturally.

Break a leg!
Stage Crew

Microphone Rules for the English Speech Contest — Questions

(24) Why must finalists tell the sound desk their microphone preference at check-in?

1 So judges can deduct points for using a podium.

2 Because wireless microphones cost five hundred yen to rent.

3 So stage crew can adjust the microphone stand height in advance.

4 Because only three finalists are allowed to use microphones.

(25) Why should speakers never tap or blow into the handheld microphone?

1 Moisture turns the wireless microphone off for an hour.

2 Doing so sends an unpleasant loud boom through the hall's speakers.

3 Contest rules require whispering without amplification.

4 The podium microphone breaks if someone breathes nearby.

(26) When does the sound engineer unmute a speaker's microphone?

1 Only after the speaker flips a switch on the handle.

2 Ten minutes after the speech begins.

3 While the speaker is still sitting in the audience.

4 Right as the speaker bows at center stage.

How Roman Aqueducts Moved Water by Gravity Alone

Postcard photos of ancient Roman engineering almost always feature soaring multi-tiered stone arches—like the Pont du Gard in southern France or the Aqueduct of Segovia in Spain—striding dramatically across sunlit river valleys. Looking at those monumental bridges, casual travelers often assume Roman aqueducts ran entirely above ground on stone stilts. In reality, arches made up less than ten percent of most aqueduct routes; the other ninety percent wound invisibly through stone-lined channels buried half a meter to several meters underground.

Keeping channels underground made practical sense: buried conduits stayed cool, resisted evaporation, kept dirt and grazing animals out of drinking water, and required far less quarried stone than tall arches. What made Roman hydraulic engineering extraordinary was that the entire fifty- or eighty-kilometer journey from mountain spring to city fountain relied solely on gravity, without a single mechanical pump.

Surveyors had to maintain an almost imperceptibly gentle downward slope—often dropping just fifteen to thirty centimeters per kilometer, or less than the thickness of a textbook over the length of a soccer field. Too steep a gradient turned flowing water into a scouring torrent that eroded mortar walls; too flat a channel let stagnant pools deposit silt.

Without spirit levels or laser sights, Roman engineers used a wooden T-shaped instrument called a chorobates: a six-meter beam fitted with plumb bobs on its legs and a shallow water trough carved along its top to judge true horizontal even on windy hillsides. Where a deep valley blocked the path, arches carried the channel level across; where a ridge intervened, miners chiseled straight tunnels guided by vertical air shafts.

Delivering millions of liters daily to public baths, street fountains, and workshops, gravity-fed aqueducts sustained urban populations rarely matched again in Europe until the nineteenth century.

How Roman Aqueducts Moved Water by Gravity Alone — Questions

(27) What common misconception do travelers often hold when seeing Roman aqueduct bridges?

1 They assume aqueducts ran entirely on tall arches rather than mostly underground.

2 They think Roman aqueducts were built in the nineteenth century.

3 They believe electric pumps pushed water up the stone arches.

4 They assume aqueducts carried olive oil instead of water.

(28) Why was burying ninety percent of an aqueduct channel advantageous?

1 Miners found gold coins every ten meters.

2 Underground channels needed no downward slope at all.

3 It kept water cool and clean, cut evaporation, and used far less stone.

4 Frozen ice slid faster than liquid water.

(29) Why did Roman surveyors have to keep the downward slope within a narrow range?

1 Roman citizens disliked clear water in public fountains.

2 Steep slopes caused water to flow backward up mountains.

3 Flat channels turned fresh spring water into seawater.

4 Steep slopes eroded walls, whereas overly flat ones let silt settle.

(30) How did the wooden instrument called a chorobates help engineers on windy hillsides?

1 It blasted solid rock ridges using gunpowder.

2 It pumped river water thirty meters straight up.

3 It paired plumb bobs with a water groove on top to find true horizontal.

4 It forecast summer rainfall six months ahead.

(31) What historical impact of Roman aqueducts does the author emphasize at the end?

1 They bankrupted every city that built public street fountains.

2 They sustained large urban populations unmatched in Europe for centuries.

3 They worked for only five summers before silting shut.

4 They were used exclusively by emperors inside private palaces.